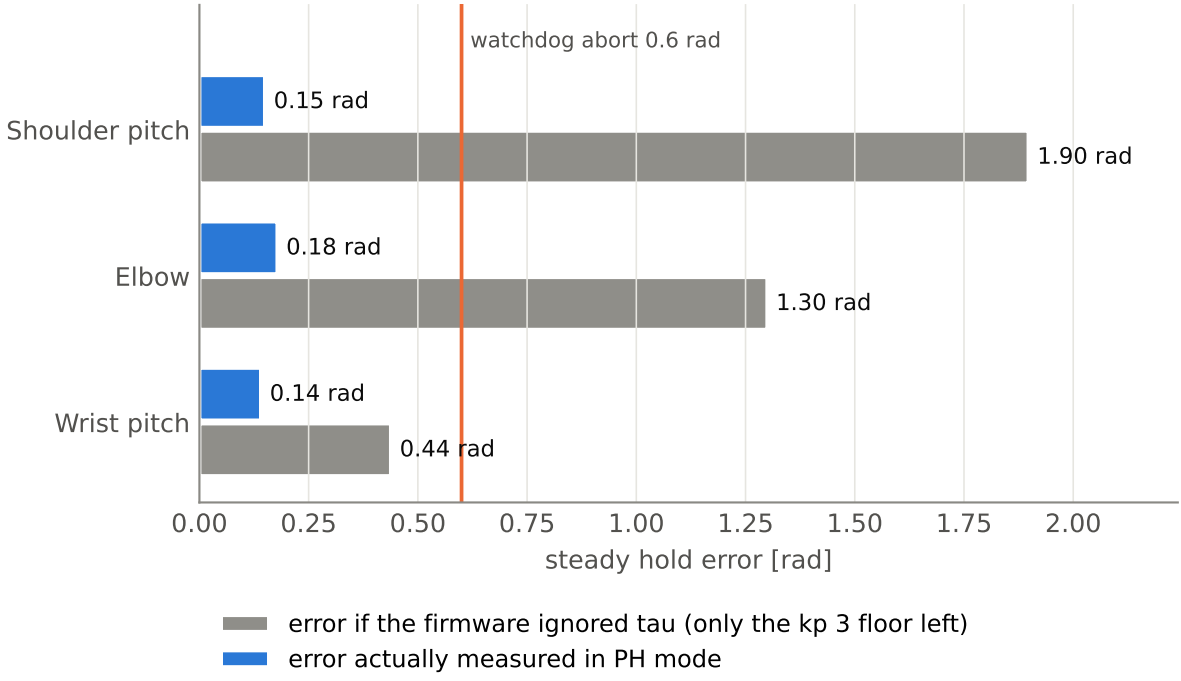
The arm firmware does apply the torque command

Without tau the weak floor would let shoulder and elbow sag past the watchdog.
The measured error is 3 to 13 times smaller, so tau reaches the motors.